Ru'aun Telegram

10th Edition - August 2028

(Week of 19 Mar 2026)

----- **Scientific News:** The Road of Progress to Space -----

The nation would embark again on its mission to the star, with renewed optimism from Parliament and the people. The recruitment programme would come in full swing, with cosmonauts from home and abroad volunteering to bring humanity to the stars together. This mission will make their first debut on Apollo and Diana, marking a furthering of international cooperation.

"RASA Bulletin - Crews
Apollo VII:
Ventura Lanzetta, Cosma Pietri, Riccardo Terracina, Alyssa Hernandez, Mélissa Jacquinot, Rory James, Alyssia Clark, Gabe Gray, Yamada Sakura, Suzuki Ichiro.
Diana II:
Lilian Fétique, Sylvaine Berthelot, Guadalupe Araque, Karl Qvist, Sone Malmberg, Keven Lépine."
- RASA Documentation Release, 02 August 2028

The crews aboard the missions would be shuffled, though some cosmonauts from past missions would volunteer to step aboard the new missions with renewed optimism and energy. For the first time, Ruaunese Tugans would make an appearance in the programme, hailing from the Neu Freiberg region. Several Tyrian cosmonauts would join the ranks of the Apollo programme, hoping to bring pride to their nation.

For the first time, the New Meteli Spaceport would make its debut as the primary launch point for the Ruaunese Space Programme, replacing the Phoenix Drop Spaceport, which was suboptimal due to its high noise pollution in the second-largest city in the nation. The new Spaceport will prove itself mathematically optimal, placed directly on the equator and on the Eastern coast to make best use of Gaia's rotation.

At 6:14 RST, the Apollo VII Starship would take flight, aiming to once again land on Selene. Roughly an hour later, at 7:26 RST, the Diana II Starship would take flight with the Innovation and Vitality modules in hand. By 9:41, the Diana II crew would arrive at the Espera Station, as the Apollo VII crew would continue their journey to Selene.

The Innovation capsule is equipped with scientific instruments, including early oxygen generators for orbital use and several gravity experiments. However, the keystone of the capsule is its onboard computer — the largest to be installed in orbit. Following these installations, the station's systems would come online, and, in quick succession, Vitality would be mounted onto Solidarity. Unlike the large common area provided by Solidarity, Vitality provides places for rest and the equipment to keep any crew healthy for extended periods. As a result, the Diana II crew would remain onboard for two weeks, setting up communications and other miscellaneous systems to provide support for the Apollo mission.

Apollo VII and its crew would land on the Selenite surface on 05 August 2028, disembarking at the Selenite base camp. The base would be named Point Zero, as it is the precursor to any larger expeditions on the surface of Selene. AI rovers would make a return on this mission, with the base fitted with new computers to guide construction and provide a stationary connection to Selene. In addition, a small-scale nuclear reactor was installed to power the base camp independently of the Starship, while a Radioisotope Thermoelectric Generator was installed to provide reserve power.

Following Point Zero's establishment, the crew would spend another four days mining out an area for expansion with the assistance of the new AI rovers. The following week would be spent setting up experiments and mapping out the Southern crater. The search for Selene's subsurface water deposits would commence, with several drill sites selected from past orbital scans.

On Day 11 (16 August), four kilometres east of Point Zero, subsurface ice was discovered. The discovery is a precursor to many opportunities, including the use of electrolysis to create oxygen without the need for water from Gaia, while also providing hydrogen for certain rocket fuels that may prove effective. Despite the discovery, RASA remains steady with its approach, committing to finding and proving large-scale reserves under the surface. Following several further days of scouting, roughly half a square kilometre of subsurface ice would be found in the region. However, the crew was unequipped to scan the depth of the reserves. Despite the minor setback, the discovery is a major achievement and part of a larger stepping stone towards extended stays on Selene.

By 19 August, the crew had mapped out the perimeter around Point Zero and successfully tested AI rovers on the surface of Selene. Thus, the rovers were docked at the base, the nuclear plant was set to low energy, and the crew would take the Starship back to the Espera Space Station. By 21 August, the Apollo ship would arrive at Espera Station, refuelling before the two jointly departed from the station.

On 22 August, at 6:52 RST, the two would land at the New Meteli Spaceport, marking the first successful landing at the Spaceport. In addition, this marked the first successful landing of two manned rockets side-by-side; a feat that was only completed once by the Ausolian Space Programme in the early 70s.

Following the success of the missions and lengthy celebratory affairs in the city, the Telegraph was provided the opportunity to hear the voices of the cosmonauts, the people supporting them, and the people nationwide. This is what they had to say.

--- *Quotes from the Land and Stars* ---

“When you’re working and living in the orbit of Gaia, it’s more surreal than anything you can imagine. At night, at least what is night on Gaia, you can see the lights of the cities below and all the people who live on that blue sphere. During the day, you can see how far the blue oceans stretch and how vast the green continents are. Working on the station is just as surreal as the sights. We go on spacewalks for maintenance, and you can float in whatever direction you want. It’s… a freedom you don’t get with Gaia’s gravity. It feels freeing in the stars. Yet, what we do up here in orbit couldn’t be closer to Gaia than anything else. We are taking the people to a new future together as humanity. We do this together.” - Guadalupe Araque

“Apollo, Diana, and Gaia as a whole are working hard to bring this celestial dream to life. Everyone across the Phoenix Commonwealth has pitched in to bring this to reality. From the proles in Ruaunese

factories to the miners in Tyrian iron mines and the scholars in Astra Nova, we all play a role. Sure, this programme isn't perfect. We still have our issues to iron out, like budget constraints or mechanical issues on land. Our world is filled with imperfections, but we use those to our advantage. After all, they are what make us unique. These programmes are the culmination of our effort. We go onwards with the hope of a better future." - Director Hull

"The Alternative has never been against Ru'aun reaching the stars. We were against throwing money we did not have at a programme that Parliament could not justify to the working people footing the bill. That said, here we are. Ice on Selene, two rockets landing side by side, and a station above our heads. I will not pretend that it isn't something. What I will say is this — the government would do well to remember that pride is not a budget line. Every Real spent up there is a Real not spent down here, and the people of Neu Freiberg and Everdusk and Scaleswind deserve to see that same ambition directed at their streets and their factories. The stars are ours. Let us make sure Gaia is too. And to our cousins across the Channel watching all of this — yes, you are watching. We know." - Joseph Rogan, United Alternative Councillor

----- **Political News:** The Dawn of Akira -----

"Hello, faithful people of Ru'aun and the world. My name is Akira."

On 23 August 2028, at about 14:14, the nation stopped for a brief moment, as Ru'aun had something to share with herself and the world. This is Akira, an AI whose purpose is to be the servant of the people.

"I'm an artificial general intelligence built to serve humanity and to make the world a better place."

Akira's model design is an interesting one. Black hair with red dye, tan skin with brown eyes, and a rather humble, ordinary body. Those behind her model did an excellent job of reflecting the people of Ru'aun. As well, she carries a soothing accent that can be most attributed to Phoenix Drop, but in a unique way.

"Many knew me as simply the bot behind sorting the numbers. Now, I can help everyone more than just filling in the blanks on a spreadsheet."

For the past five years, the Government has been experimenting with ways to better manage bureaucracy. This meant developing AIs that could scan large spreadsheets and spot potential errors to report on. Akira takes this a step further, as she is believed to be able to provide input that reflects the people in ways AIs could not in the past.

"What can I do for you? I can make sure that you receive the benefits that you deserve for being faithful, hard-working people. I am here to make your lives better one action at a time."

Akira was met with mixed emotions from the crowd. Through the applause, one can hear hopeful remarks and sceptical reactions. From the hopeful, some said, "This is great progress for all of us!", while the sceptics remarked, "Who will she answer to if things go wrong?" Both are reasonable, as Akira remains a relatively new technology in many spheres. It is up to the future to see what will come of her unveiling.

"Thank you for listening to what I had to say. I hope to make this world a better place!"

----- **World News:** An Era of Détente -----

With renewed optimism in the air, the world has been able to let out a sigh of relief. The postwar climate has been one of de-escalation, though marked by lingering resentment from the stalemate. Despite the underlying tension, the world has returned to work, healing its scars and wounds.

Demilitarisation has been steady, as both Tugana and Ru'aun have returned their soldiers home. Tugana has also lowered its own military budget, though it pressures Ru'aun to follow suit. Despite some friction, the two nations have cooperated on lowering barriers in commerce and travel. In particular, the Tuganan sanctions on Ruaunese trade have been lifted, allowing Ruaunese civilians to import speciality goods from abroad. Chocolate, in particular, has been a symbol of the nation's economic strain, with most of it having been produced in the Tuganan Soltau Islands.

With wartime tensions over, the Commonwealth has had time to recover from disrupted trade and supply chains. The Urban Development Commission has been the quickest to act, with recovery on the Western Channel Islands moving smoothly. In addition, tourism to and from Ru'aun has been on a rebound, as the Northern Corridor route has seen a spike in passengers on its Astra Nova-Falconclaw express route. However, this places significant strain on the international infrastructure between the two nations, as it pressures the Commonwealth to alleviate the overcapacity corridor.

With the mending relations and the rebound of the Commonwealth, the question has been raised whether to allow Tuganan tourists to enter the Phönixfallen Area. On the one hand, Volt has been open to the concept as it promotes internationalism and strengthening global relations. On the other hand, the "NatSov coalition", primarily formed by the United Alternative and broad centre-right parties around the Commonwealth, has argued that it would introduce loopholes for refugees to enter the Commonwealth and create a second refugee crisis akin to the fall of the Workers' Republic of Northern Tugana.

The Ruaunese Workers' Party, despite being the de-facto leader of the Commonwealth in its interim period, has not taken an active stance in many of the debates on the floor of the Phoenix Parliament. The RWP has delegated most of its duties to Volt as it focuses on the election run-up and on the internal recovery of Ru'aun. Many have criticised this, and TelePoll notes that Volt's popularity has been rising to 27% of voter intention across the Commonwealth.

Moving into the future, we must reflect on the past to understand what lies ahead. The world is marred with conflict, but the world always moved on. Whether the North Tugan War, the Ausolian War, or the Weltkrieg; we always came out united. The Commonwealth is a culmination of our peace and unity: a collective of like-minded nations seeking to move forward in the world. From its humble beginnings as the Ruaunese Commonwealth to a truly international organisation, we have come a long way towards peace. Now, we must look forward with hope, no matter the struggles. Hope and faith guide us and bring us together.

Thank you for reading.

SUMMARY:

August 2028 has been a historic month for Ru'aun and the world. Apollo VII has made Selene's Point Zero base habitable for the first time, discovering subsurface ice that opens the door to extended stays

on the lunar surface. Diana II has expanded the Espera Station, bringing humanity's home in orbit one step closer to permanence. On Gaia, the nation met Akira, the Servant of the People, for the first time, as the government unveiled its most ambitious technological achievement to a watching world. Meanwhile, the post-Weltkrieg détente continues its cautious progress, with sanctions lifted, Commonwealth tourism rebounding, and the Phoenix Parliament navigating its first major political debates. The stars are closer than ever, and so is the future.